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Securing Your Future

The sheer range of industries it finds a place in, and the increasing demand for trained professionals, mark IT security as an attractive and lucrative career option

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From the healthcare to the manufacturing sector, everyone is enjoying the advantages of being networked. As interconnectivity increases, so do its risks and perils. The number of security breaches in India has increased dramatically in the last one year alone. Just to cite a few examples, a security breach at HSBC's offshore data-processing unit cost them £233,000 (Rs 1.9 crore); the recent Monster.com breach resulted in the theft of personal data of 1.3 million users; the Bank of India Web site was infected with thirty-one Trojans that downloaded to user's computers when they visited it. These remind us of the importance of security in the IT sector.

In its latest report on the future of the IT security market, Analyst firm Global Industry Analysts (GIA) predict "stupendous growth," suggesting revenues may exceed \$79 billion (Rs 32,000 crore) by 2010. This study backs up a recent Frost & Sullivan report on the security services market, which is predicted to reach \$2,900 billion (Rs 12,000 crore) by end 2007.

The security sector offers one the opportunity of being up-to date with the latest news, software, and security exploits of the day. If you have

the aptitude to learn something new every day, and if you have the slightest interest in news of viruses and the like—read on!

Getting Started

There is no specific emphasis given to the subject of security in any software engineering or graduation degree syllabus.

Computer education in India focuses on grooming students to be software application developers.

Therefore to find a place in the Security market, you first have to understand it.

This market is layered in three categories: the Product-led, Consulting-led, and Specialist-led approaches.

The product-led approach means you'll work with companies that provide OS-level security, Internet-related security, and anti-virus and anti-spam products. This is the first step towards the security industry.

Here, you learn all about a particular security product and specialise in it.

This approach branches out into a multitude of designations.

Software Engineer/Developers write secure code that is used to build an application. This code has to comply with security parameters set during the development of the application.



Illustration Chaitanya Surpur